XIAOYU SUN

Email: xsun052@uottawa.ca Tel: +1(613)227-8106
Address: 55 Laurier E., Ottawa, ON, Canada, K1N 6N5
Website: https://rainiesun.github.io/xiaoyusun.github.io/

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Management (Finance), Telfer School of Management, University of Ottawa (Canada), 2020-Present
- MSc. in Finance and Investment with Distinction, University of Leeds (UK), 2017-2018
- BSc. (Honours) in Economics, Dalhousie University (Canada), 2015-2017
- BSc. in Economics, Shandong University of Finance and Economics (China), 2013-2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

ESG, Climate Finance, Biodiversity, Institutional Investors, Retail Investors, Corporate Bonds, Empirical Asset Pricing

THESIS

"Factor Investing in Corporate Bond Mutual Funds" (Job market paper)

- Presentations: *Asian Finance Association (AsianFA) (2026); Annual Telfer Conference in Accounting, Auditing, and Accountability (2026); FMA (2025); Research Seminar of Telfer, University of Ottawa (2025).*

"Despite the widely recognized importance of factors in asset pricing and the rapid growth of factor investing, little is known about how factor strategies are implemented in corporate bond portfolios. Using detailed holdings of U.S. corporate bond mutual funds, I provide novel evidence on their factor exposures and associated performance implications. I find that funds generally tilt against well-known academic factors, and these contrarian tilts are highly persistent. Although managers capture significant premia through several factor tilts at the bond-holdings level, these premia often fail to translate into superior fund performance. Instead, funds that tilt toward the factors generally underperform peers that tilt against them. Liquidity management costs and heterogeneous portfolio allocations significantly offset the return benefits of factor investing. Overall, the findings indicate that the practical value of factor investing in corporate bond mutual funds is attenuated and often eroded relative to what bond-level premia imply."

"Mutual Fund Tournaments and ESG Ratings", with Fabio Moneta

- Published *Journal of Business Ethics*
- Funded by Telfer SMRG Research Development Grant
- Presentations: *The 3rd Conference on Sustainable Banking and Finance (CSBF) (2025)*; EFMA (2025); Canadian Sustainable Finance Network (CSFN) Conference (2025); FMA (2024); The 12th SIIFC International Conference & 8th Shanghai-Edinburgh-London-Cape Town Green Finance and Accounting Conference (2024); Department of Economics,*

* Presented by co-author.

University of Ottawa (2024); Research Seminar of Telfer, University of Ottawa (2023).

"Retail Investor, Liquidity and the Decline in Stock Return Predictability", with Fabio Moneta

- Under review
- Presentation: *FMA (2026); SFA (2026, scheduled); The Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (EIEF) (2026)*; EFMA (2025)*

WORKING IN PROGRESS

"Do Mutual Funds Care about Biodiversity Risk", with Jingyu Zhang (Queen's University) and Fabio Moneta

- Presentation: *FMA New Ideas Session (2026); Climate Finance & Sustainability Conference (2026)*

"Corporate Insider Trading and Fund Trading: Evidence from Corporate Decarbonization Commitment", with Jingyu Zhang and Fabio Moneta. Funded by SSHRC-NFRF-Exploration 2025.

"Sophisticated Retail Investors", with Fabio Moneta

"Corporate Twitter Use and Retail Trading", with Fabio Moneta

"Generative AI Boosts Productivity Across the Expertise Ladder", with Institute of Replication

TEACHING AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Independent Lecturer

- ADM3352 Portfolio Management, University of Ottawa, Fall 2026
- ADM3352 Portfolio Management, University of Ottawa, Winter 2026
- ADM3351 Fixed-Income Investment, University of Ottawa, Fall 2024
- ADM3351 Fixed-Income Investment, University of Ottawa, Winter 2024
  (Course enrollment: 72, Average course evaluation score: 4.56/5.00)

Teaching Assistant (2021-2026): Equity Evaluation, Corporate Finance, International Business, Finance Theory, Financial Management, Operation Management, Portfolio Management, Multinational Business Finance, Statistics Management, Mathematics for Business.

Research Assistant:

- Research Assistant for Prof. Fabio Moneta, University of Ottawa, 2021 - 2026
- Research Assistant for Prof. Suhaib Riaz, University of Ottawa, 2022

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Presentations

- Financial Management Association (FMA), 2024; 2025; 2026
- Southern Finance Association (SFA), 2026 (scheduled)
- Climate Finance & Sustainability Conference (2026)
- Asian Finance Association (AsianFA), 2026
- The Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (EIEF), 2026*
- Annual Telfer Conference in Accounting, Auditing, and Accountability, 2026
- The 3rd Conference on Sustainable Banking and Finance (CSBF)*, 2025
- European Financial Management Association (EFMA), 2025
- Canadian Sustainable Finance Network (CSFN) Conference, 2025
- The 12th SIIFC International Conference & 8th Shanghai-Edinburgh-London-Cape Town Green

Finance and Accounting Conference, 2024
- The Marleau Lecture Series on Economic and Monetary Policy, Department of Economics, University of Ottawa, 2024
- Research seminar of Telfer School of Management, University of Ottawa, 2023; 2025

Camps and Conferences (Participant)

- The University of Ottawa AI Replication Games, Institute of Replication, 2025
- SAIF-CAFR Financial Research Summer Camp, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2025
- Symposium on Fintech Innovation, Telfer School of Management, 2025
- Annual Telfer Conference in Accounting, Auditing, and Accountability, 2025; 2026
- Telfer Conference on Corporate Finance and Banking, 2023; 2024; 2025; 2026
- Symposium on Responsible Investing, Telfer School of Management, 2024

AWARD AND GRANTS

Doctorate Admission Scholarship, University of Ottawa, 2020 - 2025
International Doctoral Scholarship, University of Ottawa, 2020 - 2025
PhD Graduate Student Conference Travel Support, University of Ottawa, 2024; 2025; 2026

WORK EXPERIENCE

Market Strategy Analyst, Changcheng Security Co., Ltd., Shenzhen, China, 2019 - 2020

SKILLS

Programming Skills: SAS, Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, Excel, LaTex
Certification: CFA Level I
Language: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Prof. Fabio Moneta, Full Professor of Finance
Co-Director for the Microprogram Capital Markets; RBC Financial Group Fellowship in Finance
Telfer School of Management, University of Ottawa
moneta@telfer.uOttawa.ca
613-562-5800 x 4778

Prof. Adelphe Ekponon, Associate Professor of Finance
Telfer School of Management, University of Ottawa
ekponon@telfer.uOttawa.ca
613-562-5800 x 8829

Prof. Qianru Qi, Associate Professor of Finance
Telfer School of Management, University of Ottawa
Qianru.Qi@telfer.uOttawa.ca
613-562-5800 x 4700